

7.6 Issues and debates	Examples of issues and debates in child psychology: • Ethics (e.g. balancing participation and protection rights and the UNCRC). • Practical issues in the design and implementation of research (e.g. in meta-analyses, with special issues about comparing results from different studies; in observations and getting objective data). • Reductionism can be discussed (e.g. reducing behaviour to the Strange Situation in order to test attachment types). • Comparisons between ways of explaining behaviour using different themes (e.g. Ainsworth's and Bowlby's theories about attachment; evolution ideas about attachment). • Psychology as a science (e.g. looking at how cross-cultural research can answer questions about nature-nurture, so looking at what is universal in child development). • Culture (e.g. cross-cultural findings about attachment types and cultural differences in child rearing) and gender (not considered directly but studies do look at differences in gender, day care, and social, emotional and cognitive development). • Nature-nurture (e.g. what cross-cultural studies say about the universality of attachment types). • An understanding of how psychological understanding has developed over time (e.g. Bowlby's work has been followed up with more recent studies on maternal deprivation linking to issues around day care). • Issues of social control (e.g. how findings about day care and parenting styles/attachments can be used as a form of control such as advising day care (or not) for economic reasons; treatment, therapy and behaviour around the issue of autism). • The use of psychological knowledge within society (e.g. treatment or therapy for problem behaviour; pros and cons of day care and advice to parents; advice regarding looked after children). • Issues related to socially sensitive research (e.g. research into developmental issues such as autism; research into issues around child development such as socio-economic status; research around adoption and the effects of privation).
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